

Levi Taylor - Web Developer

Wellington, Aotearoa - NZ Citizen

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About Me

I'm a web developer with a background in customer service and a passion for gaming. I've worked many jobs where websites or software systems have been inefficient or problematic, and getting them fixed takes months, if not years, due to the backlog.

For example, when I worked in the inbound call centre at ANZ, we used seven different websites and systems to assist customers with services like password resets or bank payments. Due to the delay in app development, customers must call for assistance, which creates unnecessary frustration for them, as well as causing delays for more urgent calls like fraud or robbery. On the staff side, these websites were extraordinarily complicated, leading to long training periods, staff errors, and staff frustration.

How great would it be if I could improve these websites myself as soon as I notice an issue? What if I could create one website that combined all the functions that ANZ needs into one user friendly interface? That's why I've been studying full stack development at Dev Academy.

I'm looking for a career where I can help workplaces improve efficiency, reduce staff and customer frustration, and perhaps even boost morale and team bonding by embedding small games. I'll bring initiative, critical thinking skills, and attention to detail.

Check out my LinkedIn profile to see my full customer service history!

Skills

- **Frontend:** I've built dynamic user interfaces using React, TypeScript and styling frameworks like Tailwind and Sass
- **Backend:** I've developed server-side logic, API endpoints, and RESTful routing with Node.js and Express
- **Database Management:** I've configured and queried relational databases using SQLite, Knex, and cloud-based tools like Turso
- **Authentication:** I've integrated Auth0 for secure user login, session management, and JWT validation
- **Third-Party Integrations:** I can bridge external tools and data sources like the Nookipedia API
- **Initiative & Problem-solving:** I'm motivated by identifying inefficiencies and building practical solutions to fix them
- **Collaboration & Leadership:** I can work with teams to deliver a project outcome, and I can help manage other team members.

Experience

Dev Academy - Software Developer Trainee - Jul 2026 to Sep 2026

Dev Academy Aotearoa is an intensive full time software development programme that simulates real work. We completed over 800 hours of hands-on learning where we did problem solving exercises under time constraints and we grew human skills like communication, conflict resolution, teamwork, and feedback.

Yoobee College - IT Trainee - Jan 2026 to Jul 2026

At Yoobee I learned how to apply development life cycle models to support business practices, while using data models to enhance operations. I had hands-on experience with coding tools like Python which I used to create a Kiwisaver Lump Sum Calculator. I also worked with two other classmates to deliver a cybersecurity presentation.

ANZ Bank – Service Consultant – Nov 2024 to Dec 2025

At ANZ I provided first contact resolution over the phone, assisting customers with transaction investigations, credit card enquiries, and complaint resolution. I also instructed customers how to use their GoMoney App and provided product knowledge and suitable recommendations. This role gave me flexible communication skills as I regularly had to adapt my language based on the customers' financial or technological literacy. It also taught me empathy, problem-solving skills, and to stay calm under pressure while I resolved issues for angry or scared customers. The frustration of having to use multiple sites and systems to assist with a single enquiry is what finally pushed me to begin my career in software development.

MITO – Regional Coordinator – Mar 2020 to Feb 2024

I had various roles at MITO, one of which is where I managed the credit and qualification reporting to TEC via the Industry Training Register. When an apprentice completes a credit or qualification, our CRM would send a digital message to update TEC. These messages would occasionally contain errors which would block the messages from sending. My role was to investigate the messages to determine the error and resolve it so we could accurately report completions. This was my first introduction to reading and debugging code.

Projects

ACNH Friendship Calculator (in progress) - <https://github.com/Hotoke-2026/acnh-friendship-calculator>

A solo project for Animal Crossing New Horizons players to log their interactions with villagers and track their friendship levels.

My Role:

- Built a dynamic user interface using React, Typescript, and Sass CSS
- Used Node.js and Express to set up RESTful routes and integrate the Nookipedia API
- Integrated Auth0 JWT Validation

Outcome: Animal Crossing New Horizons players can log their interactions with villagers to track the friendship points they are earning. When the project is complete, users will see which gifts they should give to each villager to gain the most points.

Momodex - <https://github.com/Hotoke-2026/Momodex>

A Kiwi based project to identify creatures in the wild and use them to battle, created in a team of five.

My Role:

- Configured and queried relational databases using SQLite, Knex, cloud-based Turso
- Integrated Auth0 JWT Validation
- Used Vitest to ensure routes are protected
- Acted as Git Keeper and maintained the integrity of the main branch code
- Configured Render settings to deploy our project to a public site

Outcome: Users can navigate the site on the web, set up a user profile, and keep their details and history logged and secure.

Spam - <https://github.com/Hotoke-2026/spam>

A teacher-led project with games, community ratings, and other content focused on spam meat, created in a team of four.

My Role:

- Used Node.js and Express to set up API endpoints and RESTful routes
- Integrated Auth0 JWT Validation
- Used Vitest to raise code reliability

Outcome: I established a data flow for spam quizzes, improved login security, and ensured a smooth onboarding and session experience for authenticated users.

Kiwisaver Investment Calculator - <https://github.com/Levi-Taylor-Hotoke-26/kiwisaver-calculator>

A solo Python-based command-line tool created for a Yoobee assessment to calculate and project investment growth across multiple interest rates over time.

My Role:

- Developed core financial calculation logic
- Implemented data transformation functions to convert yearly totals into monthly breakdowns
- Designed robust validation loops to ensure inputs are correctly handled and error-free
- Built terminal output tables with aligned columns for both yearly and monthly summary views

Outcome: Users can input their initial investment amount and timeframe to instantly view summary projections across standard interest rates (4%, 6%, and 8%), with the option to drill down into detailed yearly and monthly breakdown tables.

Education

Dev Academy - Jul 2026 to Sep 2026 - Certificate in Applied Software Development (L6)

Yoobee College - Jan 2026 to Jul 2026 - Certificate in Information Technology (L5)

MITO - Feb 2021 to Nov 2021 - Certificate in Business (First Line Management) (L4)

Interests

Pokemon, Animal Crossing New Horizons, Runescape, TV shows and movies

References available upon request